

# CMS 708 — Every Practice Exercise, Worked

The course document sets 23 practice exercises across Modules 2, 3 and 4 and gives no solutions. This volume is all 23, written out as complete compilable programs, plus the supplied past-style questions worked in full, trace drills, error-spotting drills and a mock paper.

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**Exam:** Monday 10 Aug 2026    **Time:** 11:00 – 14:00    **Venue:** the exam hall    **Lecturer:** the lecturer

## HOW TO USE THIS PACK

**Do not read the solutions first.** Cover the code, write the program on paper, then compare. Programming is the one subject where reading the answer feels identical to knowing it and is not.

| TIME YOU HAVE          | DO THIS                                                                                                        |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 3 hours                | Write §2 exercises 4, 7, 12, 15, 18, 21 and 23 <b>by hand on paper</b> → check → then sit the mock paper (§6). |
| 90 minutes             | The seven exercises above, then the trace drills (§3) and error drills (§4).                                   |
| 45 minutes             | Skim every solution for its <b>shape</b> , then §3, §4 and the worked questions in §5.                         |
| 10 minutes at the door | §7 only — the skeletons.                                                                                       |

## 1 The four skeletons that answer almost any question

```
A · read → calculate → print
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    double a, b;
    cout << "Enter two numbers: ";
    cin  >> a >> b;
    cout << "Result: " << a + b << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

```
B · read → decide → print
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    int x;
    cout << "Enter value: ";
    cin  >> x;
    if (x >= 18) cout << "Yes" << endl;
    else        cout << "No"  << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

```
C · loop a known number of times
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    for (int i = 1; i <= 10; i++) {
        cout << i << endl;
    }
    return 0;
}
```

```
D · function + main
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

double compute(double x) {    // definition
    return x * x;
}

int main() {
    cout << compute(5) << endl; // invocation
    return 0;
}
```

Every one of the 23 exercises is skeleton **A**, **B**, **C** or **D**, or two of them combined. Recognise which before writing a line.

## Module 2 — C++ fundamentals

## 1 · STUDENT NAME, AGE AND GPA IN A SENTENCE

```
#include <iostream>
#include <string>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    string name = "Ada";
    int age = 20;
    double gpa = 3.5;

    cout << "Student " << name << " is " << age
         << " years old with a GPA of " << gpa << "." << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

## 2 · ONE VARIABLE OF EACH DATA TYPE

```
#include <iostream>
#include <string>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    int count = 42;
    double price = 19.99;
    char grade = 'A';
    bool passed = true;
    string title = "Structured Programming";

    cout << "int: " << count << endl;
    cout << "double: " << price << endl;
    cout << "char: " << grade << endl;
    cout << "bool: " << passed << endl; // prints 1
    cout << "string: " << title << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

**Note:** a `bool` prints as `1` or `0`, not `"true"/"false"`.

## 3 · FAVOURITE COLOUR AND FOOD

```
#include <iostream>
#include <string>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    string colour, food;

    cout << "Enter your favourite colour: ";
    cin >> colour;
    cout << "Enter your favourite food: ";
    cin >> food;

    cout << "Your favourite colour is " << colour
         << " and your favourite food is " << food << "." << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

4 · SUM, DIFFERENCE, PRODUCT AND QUOTIENT **HIGH YIELD**

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    double a, b;
    cout << "Enter two numbers: ";
    cin >> a >> b;

    cout << "Sum: " << a + b << endl;
    cout << "Difference: " << a - b << endl;
    cout << "Product: " << a * b << endl;

    if (b != 0)
        cout << "Quotient: " << a / b << endl;
    else
        cout << "Cannot divide by zero." << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

**Two marks hide here:** declaring the variables `double` so the quotient is not truncated, and **guarding against division by zero**.

## 5 · VOTING ELIGIBILITY

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    int age;
    cout << "Enter your age: ";
    cin >> age;

    if (age >= 18)
        cout << "You can vote" << endl;
    else
        cout << "You are too young to vote." << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

## 6 · AREA OF A RECTANGLE

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    double length, width, area;

    cout << "Enter length: ";
    cin >> length;
    cout << "Enter width: ";
    cin >> width;

    area = length * width;
    cout << "Area of the rectangle: " << area << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

7 · EVEN OR ODD USING % **HIGH YIELD**

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    int number;
    cout << "Enter a number: ";
    cin >> number;

    if (number % 2 == 0)
        cout << number << " is even." << endl;
    else
        cout << number << " is odd." << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

**The modulus idiom is worth memorising as a family:** `n % 2 == 0` even · `n % 2 != 0` odd · `n % 5 == 0` divisible by 5 · `n % 100` the last two digits · `n / 10 % 10` the tens digit. Almost every "check whether..." number question is one of these.

## THE PATTERN BEHIND MODULE 2

Every one of these seven is skeleton **A** or **B**: declare with the right type → prompt → `cin` → compute or compare → `cout` with a label. If a question in this style appears, write the skeleton first and fill the middle.



## Module 3 — control structures

### 8 · TEMPERATURE: COLD, WARM OR HOT

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    double temp;
    cout << "Enter the temperature (°C): ";
    cin >> temp;

    if (temp < 15) cout << "It is cold." << endl;
    else if (temp < 30) cout << "It is warm." << endl;
    else cout << "It is hot." << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

Why **else if** and not three separate **if** s: the chain guarantees exactly one branch runs, and each later test already knows the earlier ones failed — so `temp < 30` means "between 15 and 30" without writing both bounds.

### 9 · ATM MENU WITH SWITCH

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    int choice;

    cout << "ATM MENU\n";
    cout << "1. Check Balance\n2. Deposit\n3. Withdraw\n";
    cout << "Enter choice: ";
    cin >> choice;

    switch (choice) {
        case 1:
            cout << "Your balance is N50,000." << endl;
            break;
        case 2:
            cout << "Deposit successful." << endl;
            break;
        case 3:
            cout << "Withdrawal successful." << endl;
            break;
        default:
            cout << "Invalid choice." << endl;
    }
    return 0;
}
```

### 10 · FIRST 10 SQUARE NUMBERS

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    for (int i = 1; i <= 10; i++) {
        cout << i << " squared = " << i * i << endl;
    }
    return 0;
}
```

### 11 · PASSWORD LOOP UNTIL CORRECT

```
#include <iostream>
#include <string>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    string password;

    cout << "Enter password: ";
    cin >> password;

    while (password != "secret") {
        cout << "Wrong password! Try again: ";
        cin >> password;
    }
    cout << "Access granted!" << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

### 13 · MULTIPLICATION TABLE 1 TO 5, NESTED LOOPS

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    for (int i = 1; i <= 5; i++) {
        for (int j = 1; j <= 5; j++) {
            cout << i << " x " << j << " = " << i * j << endl;
        }
        cout << endl; // blank line after each table
    }
    return 0;
}
```

Prints 25 lines in five blocks. Outer loop = which table; inner loop = the rows of that table.

### 14 · NESTED IF: GRADE AND PASS/FAIL

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    int score;
    cout << "Enter student score: ";
    cin >> score;

    if (score >= 50) { // outer: passed
        cout << "Status: PASS" << endl;
        if (score >= 70) cout << "Grade: A" << endl;
        else if (score >= 60) cout << "Grade: B" << endl;
        else cout << "Grade: C" << endl;
    } else { // outer: failed
        cout << "Status: FAIL" << endl;
        if (score >= 45) cout << "Grade: D" << endl;
        else cout << "Grade: F" << endl;
    }
    return 0;
}
```

This is what "nested" means: the outer **if** decides pass or fail, and a whole second decision lives *inside* each branch.

### 15 · LOGIN SYSTEM, 3 ATTEMPTS **HIGH YIELD**

```
#include <iostream>
#include <string>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    string username, password;
    bool loggedIn = false;

    for (int attempt = 1; attempt <= 3; attempt++) {
        cout << "Attempt " << attempt << " of 3" << endl;
        cout << "Username: ";
        cin >> username;
        cout << "Password: ";
        cin >> password;

        if (username == "admin" && password == "secret") {
            loggedIn = true;
            break; // stop asking once correct
        }
        cout << "Incorrect. Try again.\n" << endl;
    }

    if (loggedIn) cout << "Login successful" << endl;
    else cout << "Access denied" << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

Three techniques in one answer — a counted **for** loop for the attempt limit, a **flag variable** (`loggedIn`) to remember what happened, and **break** to leave early. This is the most exam-shaped exercise in the whole document; learn it as a template.

## 12 · SUM NUMBERS UNTIL 0 IS ENTERED HIGH YIELD

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    int num, sum = 0;    // sum MUST start at 0

    do {
        cout << "Enter a number (0 to stop): ";
        cin  >> num;
        sum += num;      // adding 0 changes nothing
    } while (num != 0);

    cout << "The total is: " << sum << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

**The accumulator pattern:** declare `sum = 0` **before** the loop, add inside it, print after. Forgetting to initialise `sum` is the classic bug — it then starts at whatever junk was in memory.

## 16 · FUNCTION THAT SQUARES A NUMBER

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int square(int n) {
    return n * n;
}

int main() {
    int num;
    cout << "Enter a number: ";
    cin >> num;
    cout << "Square: " << square(num) << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

## 17 · CELSIUS TO FAHRENHEIT

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

double toFahrenheit(double celsius) {
    return (celsius * 9.0 / 5.0) + 32;
}

int main() {
    cout << "0C = " << toFahrenheit(0) << "F" << endl;
    cout << "37C = " << toFahrenheit(37) << "F" << endl;
    cout << "100C = " << toFahrenheit(100) << "F" << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

Write **9.0 / 5.0**, not **9 / 5** — the integer version gives 1 and every answer comes out wrong. Expected output: 32, 98.6, 212.

18 · BY VALUE AND BY REFERENCE IN ONE PROGRAM **HIGH YIELD**

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

void doubleByValue(int x) {           // copy
    x = x * 2;
    cout << "    inside byValue:    " << x << endl;
}

void doubleByReference(int &x) {      // the actual variable
    x = x * 2;
    cout << "    inside byReference: " << x << endl;
}

int main() {
    int a = 10, b = 10;

    cout << "Before: a = " << a << ", b = " << b << endl;
    doubleByValue(a);
    doubleByReference(b);
    cout << "After:  a = " << a << ", b = " << b << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

## OUTPUT

```
Before: a = 10, b = 10
    inside byValue:    20
    inside byReference: 20
After:  a = 10, b = 20    <--- only b changed
```

## 20 · GLOBAL AND LOCAL WITH THE SAME NAME

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int value = 100;                // global

int main() {
    int value = 50;              // local, hides the global

    cout << "Local value: " << value << endl;    // 50
    cout << "Global value: " << ::value << endl; // 100
    return 0;
}
```

The local variable "shadows" the global one. To reach the global anyway, use the **scope resolution operator** `::` — this is not in the course notes, so quoting it is free credit.

21 · STATIC LOCAL VARIABLE COUNTING CALLS **NOT IN THE NOTES**

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

void countCalls() {
    static int count = 0;    // initialised ONCE, survives calls
    count++;
    cout << "This function has been called "
         << count << " time(s)." << endl;
}

int main() {
    countCalls();           // 1
    countCalls();           // 2
    countCalls();           // 3
    return 0;
}
```

The course document sets this exercise but never teaches **static**. A **static local variable** has the **scope of a local** — visible only inside the function — but the **lifetime of a global**: it is created once, keeps its value between calls, and is destroyed only when the program ends. Remove the word **static** and the counter resets to 0 every call, printing 1, 1, 1. That contrast is the whole answer.

## 22 · RECURSIVE SUM OF 1 TO N

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int sumTo(int n) {
    if (n <= 0) return 0;    // base case
    return n + sumTo(n - 1); // recursive case
}

int main() {
    int n;
    cout << "Enter n: ";
    cin >> n;
    cout << "Sum from 1 to " << n << " = " << sumTo(n) << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

TRACE, n = 5

```
sumTo(5) = 5 + sumTo(4)
sumTo(4) = 4 + sumTo(3)
sumTo(3) = 3 + sumTo(2)
sumTo(2) = 2 + sumTo(1)
sumTo(1) = 1 + sumTo(0) = 1 + 0
→ 1, 3, 6, 10, 15
```

## 19 · SWAP TWO NUMBERS BY REFERENCE

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

void swapNumbers(int &x, int &y) {
    int temp = x;    // the third variable is essential
    x = y;
    y = temp;
}

int main() {
    int a = 5, b = 9;
    cout << "Before swap: a = " << a << ", b = " << b << endl;
    swapNumbers(a, b);
    cout << "After swap:  a = " << a << ", b = " << b << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

A **swap only works by reference** — by value it would swap two copies and the caller would see nothing. Say that sentence in the answer; it is the point of the exercise.

## 23 · RECURSIVE FIBONACCI, N TERMS HIGH YIELD

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int fibonacci(int n) {
    if (n == 0) return 0;           // base case 1
    if (n == 1) return 1;          // base case 2
    return fibonacci(n - 1) + fibonacci(n - 2);
}

int main() {
    int terms;
    cout << "How many terms? ";
    cin  >> terms;

    cout << "Fibonacci sequence: ";
    for (int i = 0; i < terms; i++) {
        cout << fibonacci(i) << " ";
    }
    cout << endl;
    return 0;
}

For terms = 8:    0 1 1 2 3 5 8 13
```

**Fibonacci needs two base cases**, because the recursive step reaches back two places. Add the remark that this naive version **recomputes the same values many times** — a point worth a mark if the question asks about efficiency.

### 3 Trace drills — predict the output

Cover the right-hand column. "What does this program print?" is the cheapest question to set and the easiest to get wrong in a hurry.

| #  | CODE                                                                                                                                         | OUTPUT               | WHY                                                                                                              |
|----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | <pre>int a = 10, b = 3; cout &lt;&lt; a / b &lt;&lt; endl; cout &lt;&lt; a % b &lt;&lt; endl;</pre>                                          | <b>3</b><br><b>1</b> | Integer division <b>truncates</b> ; % gives the remainder.                                                       |
| 2  | <pre>for (int i = 0; i &lt; 3; i++)     cout &lt;&lt; i &lt;&lt; " ";</pre>                                                                  | <b>0 1 2</b>         | Starts at 0 and stops <b>before</b> 3 — three iterations, not four.                                              |
| 3  | <pre>int i = 5; while (i &gt; 0) { cout &lt;&lt; i &lt;&lt; " "; i -= 2; }</pre>                                                             | <b>5 3 1</b>         | Stops when i reaches -1, which fails the test.                                                                   |
| 4  | <pre>int x = 0; do { cout &lt;&lt; "run "; } while (x != 0);</pre>                                                                           | <b>run</b>           | do-while tests <b>after</b> the body, so it always runs <b>at least once</b> even though the condition is false. |
| 5  | <pre>int n = 2; switch (n) {     case 1: cout &lt;&lt; "one ";     case 2: cout &lt;&lt; "two ";     case 3: cout &lt;&lt; "three "; }</pre> | <b>two three</b>     | <b>No break;</b> — execution <b>falls through</b> from case 2 into case 3.                                       |
| 6  | <pre>for (int i = 1; i &lt;= 2; i++)     for (int j = 1; j &lt;= 3; j++)         cout &lt;&lt; i * j &lt;&lt; " ";</pre>                     | <b>1 2 3 2 4 6</b>   | The inner loop runs fully for <b>each</b> outer value — $2 \times 3 = 6$ numbers.                                |
| 7  | <pre>void f(int x) { x = 99; } int main() { int a = 1; f(a);             cout &lt;&lt; a; }</pre>                                            | <b>1</b>             | Passed <b>by value</b> — the function changed only its own copy.                                                 |
| 8  | <pre>void f(int &amp;x) { x = 99; } int main() { int a = 1; f(a);             cout &lt;&lt; a; }</pre>                                       | <b>99</b>            | Passed <b>by reference</b> — the original variable was modified.                                                 |
| 9  | <pre>int f(int n) {     if (n == 0) return 1;     return n * f(n - 1); } cout &lt;&lt; f(4);</pre>                                           | <b>24</b>            | $4 \times 3 \times 2 \times 1 \times 1$ — factorial by recursion.                                                |
| 10 | <pre>int x = 5; cout &lt;&lt; (x &gt; 3) &lt;&lt; " " &lt;&lt; (x &lt; 3);</pre>                                                             | <b>1 0</b>           | A relational expression is a <b>bool</b> , printed as <b>1</b> for true and <b>0</b> for false.                  |
| 11 | <pre>void g() { static int c = 0; c++;           cout &lt;&lt; c &lt;&lt; " "; } g(); g(); g();</pre>                                        | <b>1 2 3</b>         | <b>static</b> is initialised <b>once</b> and keeps its value between calls. Without it: <b>1 1 1</b> .           |
| 12 | <pre>int i; for (i = 1; i &lt;= 5; i++) { } cout &lt;&lt; i;</pre>                                                                           | <b>6</b>             | The loop exits only <b>after</b> the update makes the test fail — a classic off-by-one.                          |

### 4 Spot the error — find the bug and name it

| # | FAULTY CODE                                                               | ERROR TYPE | FIX                                                                                              |
|---|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | <code>cin &lt;&lt; number;</code>                                         | Syntax     | Arrows the wrong way: <code>cin &gt;&gt; number;</code>                                          |
| 2 | <code>if (x = 5) cout &lt;&lt; "five";</code>                             | Logic      | <code>=</code> assigns and is always true; use <code>if (x == 5)</code> .                        |
| 3 | <code>for (int i = 0; i &lt; 5;) cout &lt;&lt; i;</code>                  | Runtime    | No update — infinite loop. Add <code>i++</code> .                                                |
| 4 | <code>int f(int n){ return n * f(n-1); }</code>                           | Runtime    | <b>No base case</b> — infinite recursion, stack overflow. Add <code>if (n == 0) return 1;</code> |
| 5 | <code>string s = 'hello';</code>                                          | Syntax     | Single quotes are for one char. Use <code>"hello"</code> .                                       |
| 6 | <code>cout &lt;&lt; "Average: " &lt;&lt; total / 4; with int total</code> | Logic      | Integer division truncates the average. Use <code>total / 4.0</code> .                           |
| 7 | A switch whose cases have no break;                                       | Logic      | Fall-through runs every later case. Add <code>break;</code> to each.                             |
| 8 | Using string with only <code>#include &lt;iostream&gt;</code>             | Syntax     | Add <code>#include &lt;string&gt;</code> .                                                       |
| 9 | <code>void swap(int x, int y){ int t=x; x=y; y=t; }</code>                | Logic      | Swaps copies only. Declare as <code>(int &amp;x, int &amp;y)</code> .                            |



| #  | FAULTY CODE                                                                                   | ERROR TYPE | FIX                                                                                                       |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 10 | Reading <code>localVar</code> in <code>main()</code> when it was declared in another function | Syntax     | Out of <b>scope</b> . Declare it in <code>main()</code> , make it global, or return it from the function. |

Name the three error types if asked: **syntax errors** break the language rules and are caught by the compiler · **logic errors** compile and run but produce the wrong answer · **runtime errors** compile but fail during execution, e.g. division by zero or infinite recursion. **Logic errors are the most dangerous because nothing warns you.**

## 5 Past-style questions, fully worked SUPPLIED

### Q1 (a) · What is structured programming and what is its importance?

**Definition** — open with this. **Structured programming** is a programming approach that emphasizes the use of **clear control structures** — sequence, selection and iteration — together with **modular design**, instead of arbitrary jumps such as the `goto` statement. Its philosophy is to **break a complex problem into smaller, manageable parts and solve each part systematically**. It emerged as a response to the tangled, unmaintainable "spaghetti code" produced by unstructured programming.

The three permitted constructs — name them, they frame the whole answer:

| CONSTRUCT        | MEANING                                         | IN C++                                                        |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Sequence</b>  | Statements executed one after another, in order | Ordinary statements                                           |
| <b>Selection</b> | A choice between alternative paths              | <code>if</code> , <code>if-else</code> , <code>switch</code>  |
| <b>Iteration</b> | Repetition of a block while a condition holds   | <code>for</code> , <code>while</code> , <code>do-while</code> |

**A line that lifts the answer:** every program, however complex, can be written using only these three constructs — which is why `goto` is unnecessary, and why banning it costs nothing and buys clarity.

### IMPORTANCE OF STRUCTURED PROGRAMMING — WRITE NINE POINTS

- Improved readability and clarity.** The logical flow mirrors human reasoning, so code can be read top to bottom rather than traced through jumps.
- Easier debugging and testing.** Errors are **isolated within modules**, so a fault can be located and fixed without reading the whole program.
- Easier maintenance and modification.** Programs can be extended gracefully over time instead of being rewritten.
- Modularity and code reuse.** A function written once can be used in many places, reducing redundancy.
- Reduced development time and cost**, because reusable, well-organised code is written once and tested once.
- Supports teamwork.** Different programmers can work on separate modules without interfering with each other.
- Manages complexity** through divide-and-conquer — large problems become sets of small, solvable ones.
- Greater reliability.** Predictable control flow means fewer of the unpredictable-jump bugs that plague unstructured code.
- A foundation for advanced paradigms.** Mastering structured programming is **essential before moving on to object-oriented programming** and larger software projects.

Close with the notes' own sentence: **structured programming replaces chaos with order**, ensuring programs are not only functional but maintainable in the long run.

### Q1 (b) · Determine the value of the following

Given  $a = -3$ ,  $b = 5$ ,  $c = -2$ ,  $d = 6$ . Apply **precedence** first —  $*$ ,  $/$  and  $\%$  bind tighter than  $+$  and  $-$  — then work left to right. **Show every step**; the marks are for the working, not the number.

#### (i) $a - b + c / 2 - d * 5$

Step 1 — do  $/$  and  $*$  first  
 $c / 2 = -2 / 2 = -1$   
 $d * 5 = 6 * 5 = 30$

Step 2 — substitute  
 $= a - b + (-1) - (30)$   
 $= -3 - 5 + (-1) - 30$

Step 3 — left to right  
 $-3 - 5 = -8$   
 $-8 + (-1) = -9$   
 $-9 - 30 = -39$

ANSWER = -39

#### (ii) $a - c + d / 2 + a^2 - 10$

Step 1 — powers and division first  
 $d / 2 = 6 / 2 = 3$   
 $a^2 = (-3)^2 = 9$  ← square of a **NEGATIVE** number is **POSITIVE**

Step 2 — substitute  
 $= -3 - (-2) + 3 + 9 - 10$

Step 3 — left to right  
 $-3 - (-2) = -3 + 2 = -1$   
 $-1 + 3 = 2$   
 $2 + 9 = 11$   
 $11 - 10 = 1$

ANSWER = 1

### TWO TRAPS IN THAT PAIR

- $a - (-2)$  is  $a + 2$ . Subtracting a negative adds. This single sign is where most of the lost marks in (ii) come from.
- $(-3)^2 = +9$ , not  $-9$  — squaring always gives a positive result.

And one for the C++ purists. In real C++ the symbol  $\wedge$  is **not** "to the power of" — it is the **bitwise XOR** operator, and it binds **more loosely than  $+$  and  $-$** . So if  $a \wedge 2$  were typed literally into a program, the compiler would read the whole line as  $(a - c + d/2 + a) \wedge (2 - 10) = (-1) \wedge (-8) = 7$ , not 1. **Answer the arithmetic question as intended** —  $a^2 = 9$ , giving 1 — **but naming this discrepancy in one line shows genuine command of the language**. To raise a number to a power in C++ you use `pow(a, 2)` from `<cmath>`, or simply  $a * a$ .

Q2 · Trace the output from the following code

```
int main() {
    int sum = 0;
    for (int i = 1; i <= 50; i++) {
        sum += i;
        cout << i << " ";
    }
    cout << "\nSum of primes between 1 and 50 = " << sum
        << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

THE TRACE

| ITERATION | I   | SUM += I         | PRINTED |
|-----------|-----|------------------|---------|
| 1         | 1   | 0 + 1 = 1        | 1       |
| 2         | 2   | 1 + 2 = 3        | 2       |
| 3         | 3   | 3 + 3 = 6        | 3       |
| 4         | 4   | 6 + 4 = 10       | 4       |
| ...       | ... | ...              | ...     |
| 50        | 50  | 1225 + 50 = 1275 | 50      |

The loop runs **50 times**, printing every integer from 1 to 50 and accumulating each into `sum`. The total is the sum of the first 50 natural numbers:

$$n(n + 1) / 2 = 50 \times 51 / 2 = 1275$$

THE EXACT OUTPUT

```
1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18
19 20 21 22 23 24 25 26 27 28 29 30 31 32 33
34 35 36 37 38 39 40 41 42 43 44 45 46 47 48
49 50
Sum of primes between 1 and 50 = 1275
```

(All fifty numbers appear on **one line** separated by spaces — they are wrapped above only to fit the page. The `\n` at the start of the last `cout` is what moves to a new line before the message.)

**THE POINT OF THE QUESTION — SAY THIS**

The program's **message is a lie**. It claims to print the **sum of primes**, but the loop adds **every integer** from 1 to 50 and never tests primality at all. The printed value **1275** is the sum of 1...50; the true sum of the primes between 1 and 50 is **328**.

This is a **logic error**, not a syntax error: the code compiles and runs perfectly, which is exactly why logic errors are the most dangerous kind. It is also a **readability failure** of the sort this course warns about — the output label does not describe what the code does.

THE CORRECTED PROGRAM, IF ASKED TO FIX IT

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

bool isPrime(int n) {
    if (n < 2) return false;           // 0 and 1 are not prime
    for (int k = 2; k * k <= n; k++) {
        if (n % k == 0) return false; // a divisor found
    }
    return true;
}

int main() {
    int sum = 0;
    for (int i = 1; i <= 50; i++) {
        if (isPrime(i)) {
            sum += i;
            cout << i << " ";
        }
    }
    cout << "\nSum of primes between 1 and 50 = "
        << sum << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

OUTPUT

```
2 3 5 7 11 13 17 19 23 29 31 37 41 43 47
Sum of primes between 1 and 50 = 328
```

**Note the modularity:** the primality test is its own function, so `main()` stays readable — the exact principle Module 1 teaches, demonstrated in the fix.

## 6 Mock paper — sit this closed-book

### RIVERS STATE UNIVERSITY · PGD COMPUTER SCIENCE · CMS 708 — STRUCTURED PROGRAMMING

Mock examination · Time allowed: 3 hours · Answer any FIVE questions · Each question carries 20 marks · All code must be complete and compilable

| Q | QUESTION                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | MARKS      |
|---|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1 | (a) Distinguish between structured and unstructured programming, using a table with at least five bases of comparison. (b) Write two short C++ programs that perform the same task — one using <code>goto</code> and one using a loop — and explain which is preferable and why. (c) What is spaghetti code?                                                          | 8 + 9 + 3  |
| 2 | (a) Explain <b>modularity</b> and <b>readability</b> and state why each matters. (b) Write a program that reads two numbers and prints their sum, difference, product and quotient <b>using a separate function for each operation</b> . (c) Why is C++ described as a structured programming language? Give three reasons.                                           | 6 + 8 + 6  |
| 3 | (a) List the six common C++ data types and give an example value of each. (b) State the five categories of operator in C++ with two examples each. (c) Write a payroll program that reads an employee's name, gross salary and tax rate, then computes and prints the net salary.                                                                                     | 6 + 5 + 9  |
| 4 | (a) Differentiate between the <code>for</code> , <code>while</code> and <code>do-while</code> loops, stating when each should be used. (b) Write a program using a <code>switch</code> statement to simulate an ATM menu. (c) Write a program that prints a multiplication table from 1 to 5 using nested <code>for</code> loops, and state how many lines it prints. | 6 + 7 + 7  |
| 5 | (a) Differentiate between passing parameters <b>by value</b> and <b>by reference</b> , using a table and a short program that demonstrates both. (b) Write a function that swaps two numbers, and explain why it must use one of the two methods. (c) Differentiate between the <b>scope</b> and the <b>lifetime</b> of a variable.                                   | 9 + 6 + 5  |
| 6 | (a) What is recursion? State the two things every recursive function must have. (b) Write a recursive function to compute the factorial of a number and trace its execution for $n = 5$ . (c) Write a recursive function to generate the Fibonacci sequence up to $n$ terms.                                                                                          | 5 + 8 + 7  |
| 7 | (a) Define modularisation and state three benefits, illustrating with a real-world analogy. (b) Compare <b>top-down</b> and <b>bottom-up</b> program design using a table of at least four aspects, with a C++ illustration of each. (c) Which would you use in practice, and why?                                                                                    | 6 + 10 + 4 |

Where every answer lives. Q1 → Vol I §2 · Q2 → Vol I §2 and exercise 4 · Q3 → Vol I §3 · Q4 → Vol I §4 and exercises 9 and 13 · Q5 → Vol I §5 and exercises 18 and 19 · Q6 → Vol I §5 and exercises 22 and 23 · Q7 → Vol I §6. **Every one of the seven is answerable from Volume I plus this pack** — which tells you how tightly this course's material maps onto its likely paper.

## 7 Walk-in sheet — the last ten minutes

### THE PROGRAM SKELETON — WRITE THIS FIRST, EVERY TIME

```
#include <iostream>
#include <string>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    // declarations
    // prompt and cin
    // process
    // cout
    return 0;
}
```

### THE TEN FACTS MOST LIKELY TO BE TESTED

- Structured** = clear control structures + modularity; **unstructured** = `goto` + spaghetti code
- Two pillars**: modularity (independent reusable units) and readability (understandable to others)
- Data types**: `int` · `float` · `double` · `char` · `bool` · `string`
- Operators**: arithmetic · relational · logical · assignment · increment/decrement
- Selection**: `if` · `if-else` · `switch` (needs `break`; and `default` :)
- Loops**: `for` = known count · `while` = unknown · `do-while` = at least once
- By value** = copy, original unchanged · **by reference** ( `&` ) = original modified
- Scope** = where accessible · **lifetime** = how long it exists
- Recursion** = a function calling itself; always needs a **base case**
- Top-down** = big picture, stepwise refinement (house) · **bottom-up** = building blocks, reusability (car)

### THE FOUR ANALOGIES — ONE SENTENCE EACH, FREE MARKS

- Unstructured code** = a traffic system where cars teleport to random roads
- Modularisation** = planning a wedding by dividing catering, decoration, music, photography, guests
- Top-down** = an architect designing a house, then plumbing and wiring
- Bottom-up** = engineers building an engine and tyres, then assembling the car

### FIVE REFLEXES THAT SAVE MARKS

- Headers and `return 0;` on every program, no exceptions.
- `cout << out, cin >> in.`
- `==` compares, `=` assigns.
- Want a decimal? Make one operand a `double` — `9.0 / 5.0`, total / `4.0`.
- Indent one level per brace. On this course, **readability is itself on the syllabus**.

### IF YOUR MIND GOES BLANK

Write the **skeleton**, then the **variable declarations** the question implies, then the **prompts** and `cin`. By the time those are on the page the logic in the middle is usually obvious — and even if it is not, most of the structure marks are already earned.